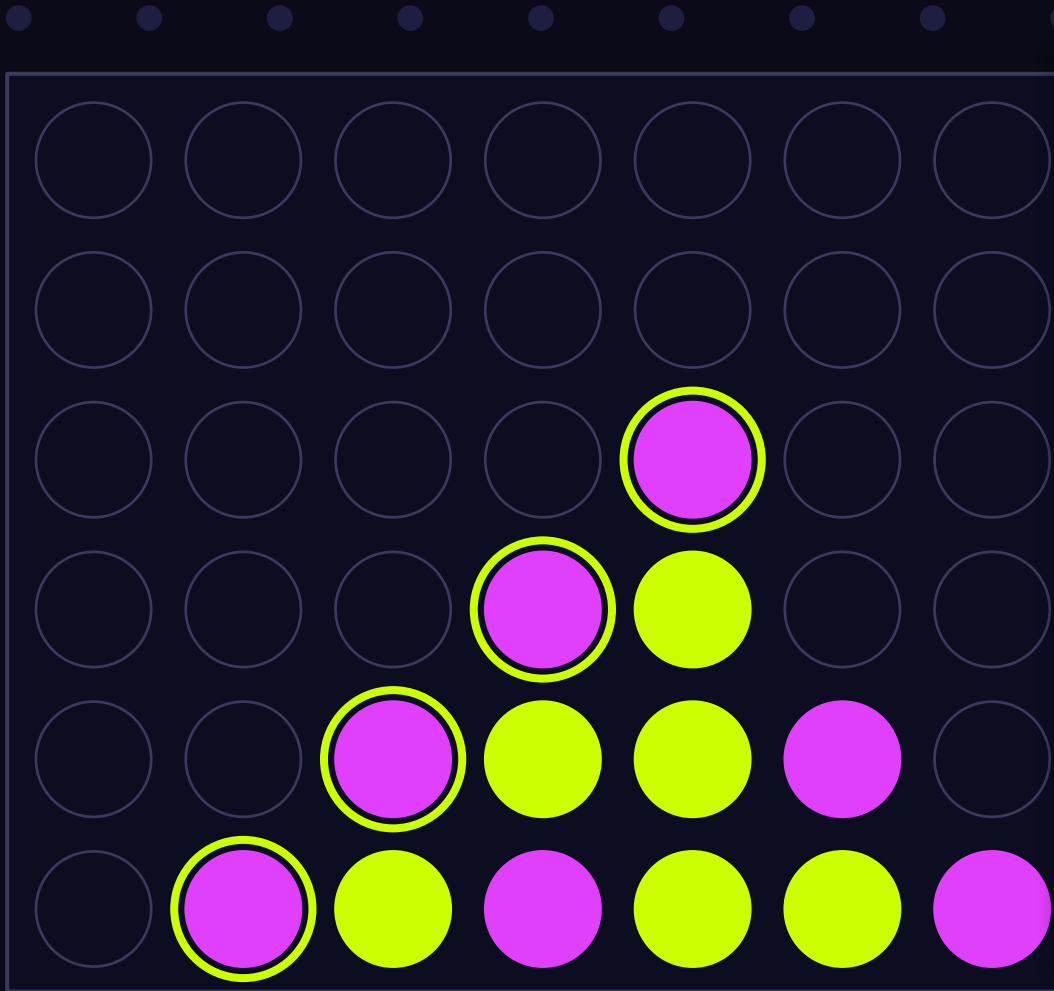




Assignment 6 · ROGUELIKE RHYTHM STRATEGY

CONNECT TO THE BEAT



*Drop on the beat. Customize your run.
Outscore your opponents. Survive.*

Designed by Delaney

THE PITCH

You and a villain are locked in an 8-song gauntlet, dropping tiles on the same board to the beat. Between rounds, spend your hard-earned coins in a rogue-lite upgrades shop. Miss the score threshold and your run ends, but every attempt unlocks new tiles and trinkets.

8

songs per run

∞

tile combos

↑ BPM

every stage

Part puzzle. Part rhythm game. Part roguelike. All on one 7×6 grid.

Think: Crypt of the NecroDancer × Connect 4 × Slay the Spire

HOW A RUN WORKS



SONG STARTS

Track plays at set BPM.
Both you and the npc
drop tiles on the beat.



SCORE!

On-beat drops earn bonus
points.
Connect 4s clear the board.
Rival penalties hurt you.



THE SHOP

Hit the threshold → shop.
Buy special tiles & trinkets
to power the rest of the
run.



BOSS ROUND

Every 4th song: a villain.
Faster BPM. Nastier tiles.
Beat their score or die.

✗ Miss the score threshold → Run ends. Final score posted. Try again with new strategy.

CORE MECHANICS

RHYTHM & SCORING

Beat 1 (downbeat) **100 pts**

Beat 2 **75 pts**

Beat 3 **50 pts**

Beat 4 **25 pts**

Off-beat **0 pts**

Chain ×3 on-beat **+2% per chain**

Connect 4 clear **+500 pts**

Opponent Connect 4 **-200 pts penalty**

TILE QUEUE & ROGUELIKE

Tile Preview

See your next 3 tiles and the rival's next tile: plan placement or go defensive.

Special Tiles

Bomb tiles clear a column. Mirror tiles copy the rival's last move. Anchor tiles can't be moved by bombs.

Trinkets

Passive items bought in the shop. Examples: +10% to all Beat 1 drops, chain bonus activates at ×2 instead of ×3.

BPM Ramp

Each stage bumps tempo slightly. Boss rounds spike it hard. Start at 80 BPM, top out around 140.

WHO IS THIS FOR?



Roguelike Fans

Run-based structure, shop meta-game, and escalating difficulty scratch the same itch as Slay the Spire or Hades.



Rhythm Game Players

On-beat scoring, BPM progression, and beat-1 chain mechanics feel native to anyone who's played Guitar Hero or Beat Saber.



Puzzle / Strategy Fans

The tile queue system and rival preview turn every drop into a decision: block, extend, or bank the beat?



Score Chasers

Threshold gates, penalty systems, and a persistent high-score board reward mastery across multiple runs.

PLAYTESTING

TEST SETUP

Format: Verbal prototype walkthrough

Testers: 2 friends, one conversation

Method: Described the concept, got reactions

"The timing might be hard."

Fair concern, addressed by starting at 30 BPM and ramping gradually. Rhythm games always teach through pacing, not pressure.

 **Noted — pacing is a core design lever**

"What's a rhythm game?"

Useful signal: the mechanic needs clear in-game tutorialization. Also confirms the game has crossover appeal beyond the core rhythm audience.

 **Insight — tutorial design is critical**

KEY INSIGHT FROM TESTING

Both responses pointed to the same design priority: gradual skill-building over front-loaded difficulty. The BPM ramp (30→100) directly answers the timing concern by teaching through pacing rather than pressure. The friend who didn't know what a rhythm game is confirmed the concept is accessible enough to explain verbally, which means a short in-game tutorial should be sufficient to onboard any player.

DESIGNER'S NOTE

01

The biggest design inspiration was the idea to turn it into a roguelike of sorts, which i think took it from an ok game concept to a much better one. playing connect 4 to a rhythm could be neat on it's own, but allowing there to be upgrades and stuff makes it seem like a much better concept

02

I think balancing the score thresholds might be tricky, it needs to feel achievable in early rounds even for players still learning the BPM, while still punishing sloppy play by the time the boss arrives, which means the curve has to teach the game as it escalates.

03

Going forward, I'd want to spend more time developing the shop items and economy, making the shopping and upgrade experience feel worthwhile, and testing different boss mechanics or opponents to face and make it feels fulfilling and worthwhile.

Game Type

Roguelike / Rhythm

Players

1 (vs AI rival)

Run Length

8 songs

BPM Range

30 → 100